

DIMETHYLAMINOPROPYLAMINE

_____Name

_____Date

also called...**DMAPA** or **3-dimethylaminopropylamine**.

What is it?

Diethylaminopropylamine (DMAPA) is an impurity left when **cocamidopropyl betaine** (CAPB) is produced from coconut. CAPB is a sudsing agent that is present in most shampoos, bath gels, bar soaps, and liquid soaps.

Where might it be found?

liquid hand soap
bar soap, body wash
hand cleanser
shower or bath gel
baby wash
bubble bath
skin cleanser
facial cleanser
makeup remover
shave gel
acne wash
acne treatment, scrub
exfoliating wash
moistened washcloths
cleansing pads
anal hygiene product
gynecologic product
shampoo
hair conditioner
hair mousse, gel, foam
hair color
hair bleach
contact lens cleaner
toothpaste
mouthwash
antiseptic
liquid detergents
household cleaners
surface cleaners
pet care products

Industrial uses:

Epoxy resin hardener
Ion-exchanger production
Additive in fuel, dyes,
pesticides, binding agents

Dermatitis from shampoo can occur on the scalp, face, neck, eyelids, or ears. Face cleansers may cause face and eyelid dermatitis, and body washes can lead to widespread rash. Genital or perianal involvement can occur from local use of antiseptics or cleansers with CAPB. Using contact lens cleaners that contain it may lead to eyelid dermatitis or conjunctivitis. Hairdressers often have their hands and forearms affected.

How to avoid it:

To avoid DMAPA in your personal products, you must avoid CAPB. Check the complete ingredient list of each product you use for **cocamidopropyl betaine**. For products already at home that do not list ingredients, go to the store and inspect the original box or package.

Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

Ask your hairdresser, barber, aesthetician, and caretakers to avoid using products with cocamidopropyl betaine in your care.

To identify possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of each product you encounter. If you must come in contact with this agent at work or as you care for children, elders, or pets, wear protective nitrile, rubber, or vinyl gloves.

If you are unable to find substitute products that are free of this allergen, your dermatologist may provide you a list from the ACDS CAMProgram.